EPIC CAMPUS - GENERAL ENGLISH

Placement test: Paper 1 - questions and answers

Teacher copy: correct answers marked

Three parts: grammar (questions 1 to 20), vocabulary (21 to 30) and reading (31 to 40). The questions get harder as you go. Answer every question; there is no penalty for a wrong answer. Time: 45 minutes.

Part 1: Grammar

> Choose the word or words that best complete each sentence.
>
> The first questions are easy and they get harder. Do your best on every question, and guess if you are not sure.

Questions 1 to 20. Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

1. She ___ a student.

A am **B** **is ✔** **C** are **D** be

Answer B. He / she / it takes "is".

2. They ___ from Kandy.

A is **B** am **C** **are ✔** **D** be

Answer C. We / you / they take "are".

3. ___ you like tea?

A **Do ✔** **B** Does **C** Are **D** Is

Answer A. Present simple questions with "you" use "do".

4. He ___ to work every day.

A go **B** **goes ✔** **C** going **D** is go

Answer B. He / she / it: add -es to "go".

5. There ___ two banks in my town.

A is **B** **are ✔** **C** be **D** has

Answer B. Plural: "there are".

6. Be quiet, please. I ___ TV right now.

A watch **B** **am watching ✔** **C** watches **D** watched

Answer B. "Right now" needs the present continuous.

7. My sister is ___ than me.

A tall **B** **taller ✔** **C** tallest **D** more tall

Answer B. Short adjective comparative: tall → taller.

8. We ___ in Galle last year.

A live **B** lives **C** **lived ✔** **D** are living

Answer C. "Last year" needs the past simple.

9. "___ did you go yesterday?" "To the market."

A What **B** **Where ✔** **C** Who **D** Which

Answer B. The answer is a place, so "Where".

10. I have ___ apple and a banana.

A a **B** **an ✔** **C** the **D** some

Answer B. "An" before a vowel sound.

11. She can ___ English very well.

A **speak ✔** **B** speaks **C** speaking **D** to speak

Answer A. After "can" use the base verb.

12. How ___ water do you drink every day?

A many **B** **much ✔** **C** long **D** often

Answer B. Water is uncountable: "how much".

13. I'm going ___ visit my grandmother tomorrow.

A **to ✔** **B** for **C** at **D** on

Answer A. "Be going to" + verb.

14. He didn't ___ to the party.

A **come ✔** **B** came **C** comes **D** coming

Answer A. After "didn't" use the base verb.

15. This is the ___ book I have ever read.

A good **B** better **C** **best ✔** **D** most good

Answer C. Superlative of "good" is "the best".

16. Have you ever ___ to Korea?

A go **B** went **C** **been ✔** **D** going

Answer C. "Have you ever been…" for experiences.

17. If it rains tomorrow, we ___ at home.

A stay **B** **will stay ✔** **C** stayed **D** would stay

Answer B. First conditional: if + present, will + verb.

18. You ___ smoke here. It's not allowed.

A **mustn't ✔** **B** don't have to **C** needn't **D** can

Answer A. "Not allowed" means "mustn't".

19. The letter ___ yesterday.

A sent **B** **was sent ✔** **C** is sending **D** has send

Answer B. Past passive: was + past participle.

20. I've lived here ___ 2019.

A for **B** **since ✔** **C** from **D** ago

Answer B. "Since" with a point in time.

Part 2: Vocabulary

> Choose the best word for each sentence.
>
> Read the whole sentence before you choose.

Questions 21 to 30. Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

21. My mother's brother is my ___.

A cousin **B** **uncle ✔** **C** nephew **D** grandfather

Answer B. Your parent's brother is your uncle.

22. You buy medicine at a ___.

A bakery **B** **pharmacy ✔** **C** library **D** post office

Answer B. Medicine is sold at a pharmacy.

23. The opposite of "cheap" is ___.

A **expensive ✔** **B** easy **C** small **D** early

Answer A. Cheap ↔ expensive.

24. I usually ___ a shower in the morning.

A do **B** make **C** **have ✔** **D** go

Answer C. We say "have a shower".

25. A person who flies a plane is a ___.

A driver **B** **pilot ✔** **C** sailor **D** engineer

Answer B. A pilot flies planes.

26. Please ___ your name at the top of the page.

A **write ✔** **B** say **C** tell **D** speak

Answer A. You write your name on paper.

27. It's very cold. Put on your ___.

A sunglasses **B** **jacket ✔** **C** sandals **D** shorts

Answer B. A jacket keeps you warm.

28. I was ___ because I didn't sleep last night.

A **tired ✔** **B** tiring **C** boring **D** excited

Answer A. -ed adjectives describe how you feel.

29. The train was late, so we ___ the meeting.

A lost **B** **missed ✔** **C** forgot **D** left

Answer B. You "miss" an event when you are late.

30. She is very ___. She always helps other people.

A lazy **B** **kind ✔** **C** rude **D** shy

Answer B. Helping others is kind.

Part 3: A student in Korea

> Kasun is twenty years old and comes from Matara, a city on the south coast of Sri Lanka. Last year he won a partial scholarship to study engineering at a university in Daejeon, South Korea. Before he left, he studied Korean for six months, but when he arrived he found that people spoke much faster than his teachers in Sri Lanka.
>
> For the first semester, Kasun took a Korean language course every morning and had engineering classes in the afternoon. The scholarship paid half of his tuition fees, so he found a part-time job in a café near the university. He worked there three evenings a week. At first he was very nervous when customers spoke to him, but after two months he could take orders without any problems.
>
> Kasun lives in a university dormitory with a student from Mongolia. They speak Korean to each other because it is the only language they share. "It was difficult at the beginning," Kasun says, "but now my Korean is much better because I have to use it every day."
>
> In winter the temperature in Daejeon sometimes falls below zero. Kasun had never seen snow before,

> and he says the first snowfall was one of the best days of his life. Next year he hopes to apply for a full scholarship.

Questions 31 to 35. Do the statements agree with the text? Choose TRUE, FALSE or NOT GIVEN.

31. Kasun's home town is on the coast.

Answer TRUE. Matara is "a city on the south coast".

32. Kasun studied Korean for a year before he went to Korea.

Answer FALSE. He studied Korean for six months.

33. Kasun's scholarship pays all of his tuition fees.

Answer FALSE. It pays half of his fees.

34. The café is the most popular café near the university.

Answer NOT GIVEN. The text does not say how popular the café is.

35. Kasun saw snow for the first time in Korea.

Answer TRUE. He "had never seen snow before".

Questions 36 to 40. Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

36. What does Kasun study at university?

A Korean **B** Business **C** **Engineering ✔** **D** Medicine

Answer C. He won a scholarship "to study engineering".

37. How often does Kasun work at the café?

A Every evening **B** **Three evenings a week ✔** **C** At weekends **D** Every morning

Answer B. "He worked there three evenings a week."

38. Why was Korean difficult for Kasun when he arrived?

A **People spoke quickly ✔** **B** His teachers were bad **C** He forgot his words

D Nobody spoke to him

Answer A. People "spoke much faster than his teachers".

39. Why do Kasun and his roommate speak Korean?

A Their teacher told them to **B** **It is the only language they both know ✔**

C They want to pass a test **D** They don't like English

Answer B. "It is the only language they share."

40. What does Kasun want to do next year?

A Go home **B** Change university **C** **Apply for a full scholarship ✔** **D** Work full-time

Answer C. He "hopes to apply for a full scholarship".